



The Truth Is Unrepentant

JACOB DAUM

1.

I've left that self who brings the sprouting of new leaves, who waters the earth, who cracks the whip and drives the mules, who plants the harvest and claps his hands, who makes the gears turn, somewhere else entirely.

Oh, where have I stowed you away, you cowardly bastard?

Must the road to you be paved in fire? Must I walk on coals, skin melting in a bright ocean of pain, must I unsheathe my sword and thrust and penetrate and slash into life furiously, must I thrash and flow like the sea, lightning cracking, waves crashing and churning with the unbridled violence of man's spirit, must I smash skulls with stone into smithereens, crush any subtlety into amorphous nothingness?

Will you ever emerge again from your drunken stupor, hiding away in that scant watering hole at the end of the world, shivering in your knit blanket, teeth chattering, pinned to the wall by your fear?

Come with me, man, I feel you near, take my hand - linger, stay by the flame I've kindled here, don't drift back to that distant dream. Take this pen from me and rise from the haze, crawl out into these lines, drive me forward, and I swear to God we will thread the needle together.

For what is a hero but a gangrenous tumor? Nurtured tenderly by a loving hand, nourished by life's plump and fertile teat, comforted by the warmth of its bosom - cradled firmly even in the depths of night, wide-eyed and fearful as the howls of unnamed horrors tear across the plains and settle in your bones - only to rise up and lustily ravage and reshape the universe in your own image, sucking, draining the flesh and blood around you of its life force with gluttonous zeal.

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